WEDDING DAY TIMELINE

BECCA & I • WINTER WEDDING SCHEDULE

Summary: 5-Hour Photography Window (11:15 – 16:15). Exact Sunset at 15:44. Sequence strictly adheres to Hotel → Venue → Ceremony → Portraits.

Leg 1: Preparation & Ceremony

TIME	LOCATION	DETAILS & ACTION ITEMS
11:15	**Kimpton Charlotte Square**	Photographer arrives for indoor preparation & detail portraits. *Becca & I remaining strictly separate.*
11:45	**Kimpton Charlotte Square**	Brief exterior portraits outside the elegant Georgian facade.
12:10	**Mass Departure**	Becca & I, along with all staying guests, board private transport and depart immediately.
12:25	**The Scott Hotel**	Arrival. Guests are escorted to seats. Becca & I meet with the celebrant for required pre-ceremony checks.
13:00	**Wedding Ceremony**	Ceremony commences (approx. 30 minutes).
13:30	**The Scott Hotel**	Ceremony concludes. Brief window for champagne toasts and hugs with your guests.
13:40	**Venue Grounds**	**Family Group Photos.** Groomsmen/coordinator to keep family tightly assembled to maximize remaining daylight.
13:55	**Depart Venue**	Becca & I, plus the photographer, board private transport to head north for couples portraits.

Leg 2: Stockbridge & The Cobbles

14:10	**Dean Village**	Driver drop-off at Bell's Brae. Fast, high-impact portraits on the historic bridge overlooking the water.
14:25	**Circus Lane**	Short walk down into Circus Lane for the classic, curved mews cobblestone framing.
14:40	**Driver Pick-up**	Board transport at India Street for rapid transit straight to the Old Town.

Leg 3: The Historic Old Town

14:55	**City Chambers / Riddle's Court**	Driver drop-off at City Chambers/Lawnmarket. Walk into the intimate courtyard of Riddle's Court, then straight down the colorful curve of Victoria Street. **[Peak Golden Hour Light]**
15:15	**The Vennel**	Head straight up the steps for the dramatic, unobstructed Edinburgh Castle portrait backdrop.
15:30	**Driver Pick-up**	Board transport at Heriot Place (top of the stairs) for transit down to the gardens.

Leg 4: Twilight & Festive Night Lights

15:35	**Princes Street Gardens**	Portraits framing the castle silhouette against the open sky. **[Exact Sunset at 15:44 — Peak Twilight / Magic Hour]**
15:50	**Transit**	Board transport at the Mound and move over to George Street as total darkness sets in.
16:00	**The Dome Christmas Lights**	Dramatic, creative flash photography outside the iconic festive columns.
16:15	**Service Ends**	Photographer concludes. Becca & I step inside The Dome for celebratory drinks.

LIGHTING SITUATION & CREATIVE STRATEGY

WHY THE SCHEDULE IS TIMED TO THE EXACT MINUTE

The Winter Light Reality

In Edinburgh mid-winter, daylight is extremely limited and decays rapidly after 13:30. Sunset occurs at exactly **15:44**. This timeline is specifically engineered so that Becca & I are standing in front of the right backdrops at the absolute peak minutes of remaining light quality.

Lighting Phases & Shot Objectives

- **11:15 – 13:30 | Morning Diffused Ambient Light**
  Locations: Kimpton Charlotte Square → The Scott Hotel
  The schedule utilizes indoor window light for prep and shields the first looks and vows from flat or harsh midday outdoor tones.

- **13:40 – 14:40 | Early Light Decay (Low-Lying Valleys)**
  Locations: Venue Grounds → Dean Village → Circus Lane
  Captures family images at the venue immediately, then rushes to Stockbridge. Because Dean Village and Circus Lane sit in lower-lying pockets, they must be shot before the sun sinks too low and drops them completely into deep architectural shadows.

- **14:55 – 15:30 | Peak Deep Golden Hour**
  Locations: Riddle's Court → Victoria Street → The Vennel
  The ultimate couples portrait window. The winter sun skims horizontally above the horizon, warming the colorful shopfronts and bathing the historic castle steps portrait in soft, dramatic amber tones with no harsh shadows.

- **15:35 – 15:55 | Magic Civil Twilight (15:44 Sunset)**
  Locations: Princes Street Gardens
  Captures the grand open sky as it scatters deep violet, pink, and pastel hues directly against the silhouette and rising spotlights of Edinburgh Castle.

- **16:00 – 16:15 | High-Fashion Editorial Night Lights**
  Locations: The Dome
  Total darkness has set in. The photographer switches to professional off-camera flash kits, making Becca & I stand out sharply against the sparkling backdrop of thousands of festive fairy lights.

DRIVER LOGISTICS CHEAT SHEET

QUICK-REFERENCE RUN SHEET • SHARE WITH TRANSPORT PROVIDER

CRITICAL FOR THE DRIVER: Sunset is at 15:44. Missing a single pickup window will result in a total loss of natural photography light for the wedding couple. Please be at all pickup locations 5 minutes early.

12:10 — PICKUP 1 (Mass Departure)

From: Kimpton Charlotte Square (38 Charlotte Square, EH2 4HQ)

Instructions: Meet at the main entrance canopy. Board Becca & I along with all staying guests. Depart sharply at 12:10 for the Southside.

12:25 — DROP-OFF 1

To: The Scott Hotel (18 Holyrood Park Rd, EH16 5AY)

Instructions: Pull directly into the Pollock Estate private driveway loop for a clean drop-off away from main road traffic. Standby on-site.

13:55 — PICKUP 2 (Couples Portraits Begin)

From: The Scott Hotel Driveway Loop

Instructions: Board Becca & I plus the photographer. Transit immediately north to Stockbridge/Dean Village.

14:10 — DROP-OFF 2 (Dean Village)

To: Bell's Brae Bridge (Water of Leith)

Instructions: DO NOT enter the narrow lower residential loop. Execute a rapid, safe rolling drop-off right at the bridge head so the couple can step out, then immediately clear the bridge to head to the next pickup spot.

14:40 — PICKUP 3 (Circus Lane)

From: India Street (Foot of Circus Lane)

Instructions: DO NOT drive into Circus Lane (it is a tight cobble dead-end). Idle safely on India Street facing south, ready for the couple to walk out and board immediately. Transit straight to Old Town.

14:55 — DROP-OFF 3 (Old Town Drop)

To: City Chambers Quadrangle / Lawnmarket

Instructions: Drop off right at the City Chambers entry or use the Johnston Terrace turning circle/ bays. Drop off the couple and photographer here so they can walk through Riddle's Court down to Victoria Street.

15:30 — PICKUP 4 (The Vennel)

From: Heriot Place Turning Loop (via Lauriston Place)

Instructions: Approach Heriot Place strictly from Lauriston Place moving northwest. Pull up right to the bollards at the absolute top step of the Vennel stairs. Board couple rapidly; drive down to the Mound.

15:35 — DROP-OFF 4 (The Gardens)

To: Princes Street (At the Mound / National Galleries Entrance)

Instructions: Quick rolling drop-off at the Mound entrance so the couple can step straight down into the upper gardens walkway for the 15:44 sunset. Go around the block to stay close.

15:50 — PICKUP 5 & FINAL DROP-OFF

From: Princes Street (The Mound) → To: The Dome (George Street, EH2 2PF)

Instructions: Pickup at the Mound at 15:50. Execute a short drive over to George Street, dropping off directly outside the columns of The Dome for the Christmas lights shoot. Clear of duties.